

MEDIEVAL HISTORY



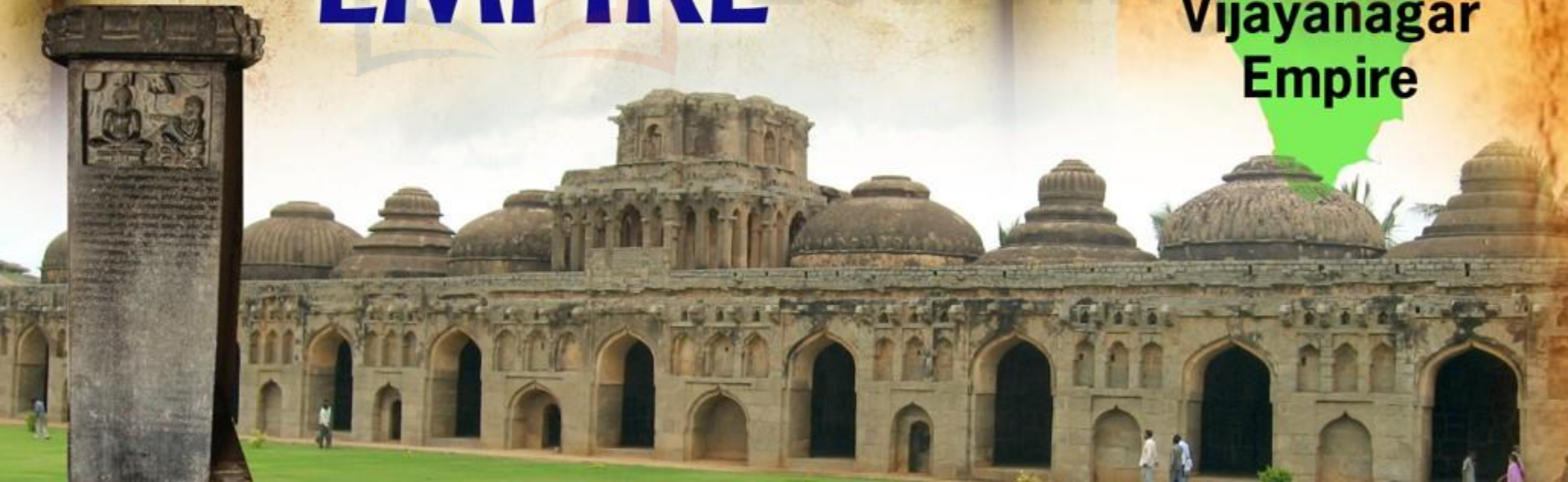
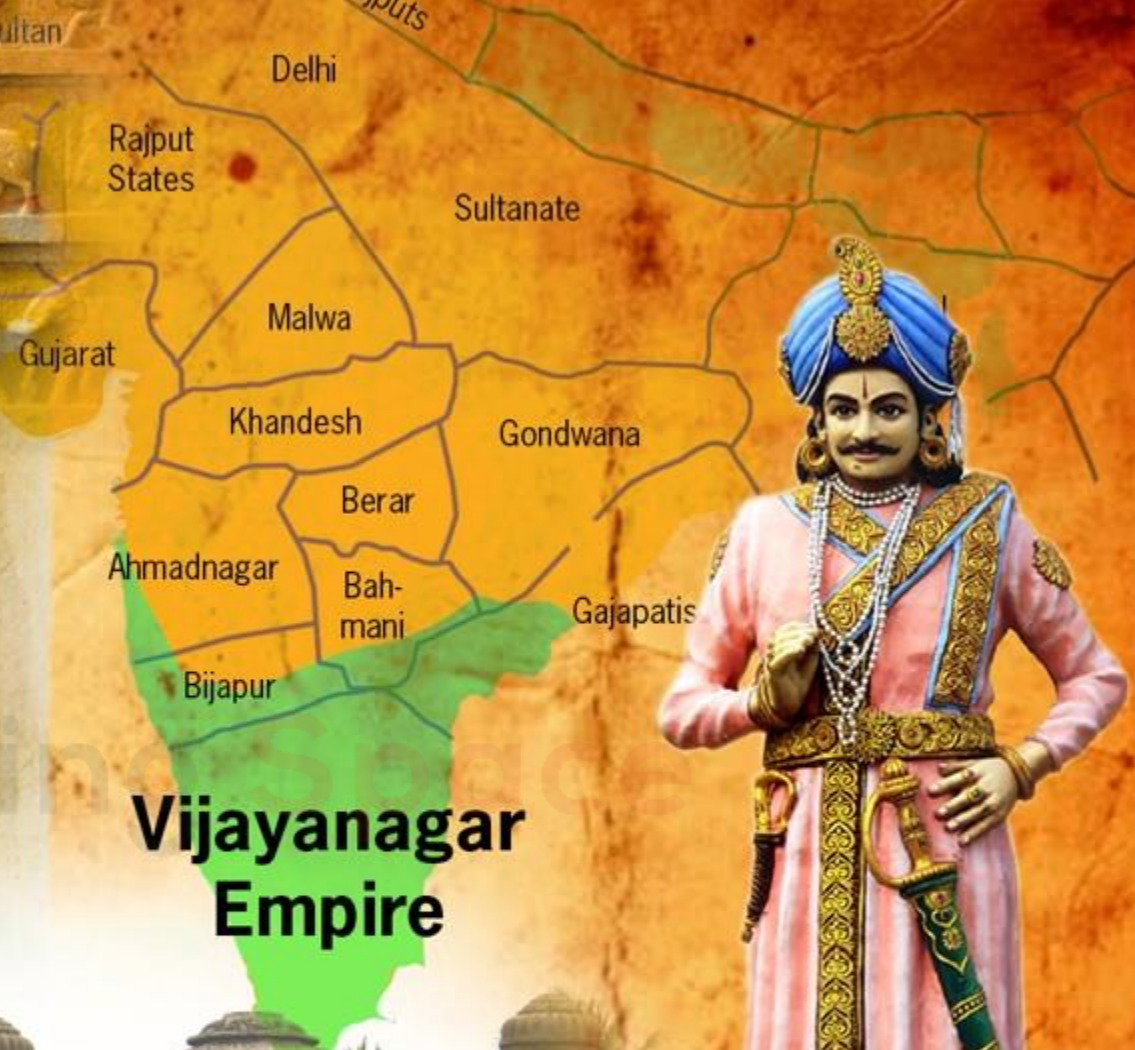
MODULE - 17

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE PART - 1





VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE



INTRODUCTION



- 1 After the 13th century (around the reign of Feroz Shah Tughlaq), due to internal weaknesses, the process of disintegration of the Delhi Sultanate started.
- 2 It was during this period that some of the provincial rulers declared their independence from the rule of the Sultanate and a large number of regional states.
- 3 The establishment of Vijayanagar and the Bahmani kingdom were a result of the assertion of power by provincial officers, like Harihara and Bukka, and Alauddin Hasan Bahman Shah, respectively.
- 4 Similarly, the Sultanates in Gujarat, Malwa, Bengal and Jaunpur near Varanasi, emerged as powerful provincial kingdoms.



DELHI SULTANATE
(Tughlaq)

SOOMRA

DEVA

GUJARAT SULTANATE

GONDWANA
STATES

GODAVARI

KRISHANA

EASTERN GANGAS

TUNGABHADRA

REDDIS

(De. occ.)
Hoysala

RAICHUR
(KARNATAKA)

Bay of Bengal

Arabian Sea

VIJAYANAGARAS

MADURAI
SULTANATE

YAPAHUWA

INTRODUCTION



- 5 4 dynasties
- Sangama (1336–1485 AD)
 - Saluva (1485–1503 AD)
 - Tuluva (1503–1570 AD) and
 - Aravidu (till the end of the 17th Century) ruled Vijayanagar from 1336 to 1672 AD

SOURCES OF INFORMATION

- ✓ Krishnadevaraya's Amuktha-malyada
 - ✓ Gangadevi's Madura-vijayam
 - ✓ Allasani Peddanna's Manucharitam
- are important indigenous literature of this period

INTRODUCTION



Foreign travellers of this period are

- ✓ Ibn Battuta (Morocco)
- ✓ Nicolò de' Conti (Italian)
- ✓ Abdur Razzak (Persian)
- ✓ Domingo Paes (Portuguese).

They left important records about the socio-economic conditions of the empire

- Sri-rangam Copper plate inscriptions of Devaraya II (gives genealogy and achievements of Vijayanagara rulers)
- Ruins of Hampi and other monuments of Vijayanagar give insight into culture.
- Numerous coins were issued explaining titles and achievements of rulers.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - SANGAM DYNASTY

POLITICAL HISTORY OF VIJAYANAGARA — SANGAM DYNASTY

HARIHARA AND BUKKA (1336–1377 AD)



- 1 Vijayanagar was founded in 1336 by Harihara and Bukka of Sangama dynasty. They were originally under Kakatiya rulers of Warangal.
- 2 They served as ministers in the Kampili state (modern Karnataka). When Kampala was overrun by Muhammad bin Tughlaq for giving refuge to a Muslim rebel, the two brothers were imprisoned and converted to Islam.
- 3 Later, they returned to the Hindu fold at the initiative of the Saint Vidyaranya.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - SANGAM DYNASTY

POLITICAL HISTORY OF VIJAYANAGARA — SANGAM DYNASTY

HARIHARA AND BUKKA (1336–1377 AD)



- 4 They also proclaimed their independence and to commemorate the memory of their guru, the brothers founded a new city of Vidyanagar or Vijayanagara (meaning city of victory) on the south bank of river Tungabhadra.
- 5 As the Hoysala kingdom ended, Harihara and Bukka expanded the Vijayanagar kingdom to contain the entire Hoysala kingdom by 1346.
- 6 The struggle between the Sultanate of Madurai and the Vijayanagar Empire had been going on in the meantime which lasted for almost 40 years.

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VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - SANGAM DYNASTY

POLITICAL HISTORY OF VIJAYANAGARA — SANGAM DYNASTY

HARIHARA AND BUKKA (1336–1377 AD)



- 7 Bukka succeeded his brother in 1356 and ruled till 1377 AD. During his reign, the Sultanate of Madurai was eliminated.
- 8 Kumara-Kampana's (son of Bukka) expedition to Madurai led to the destruction of the Madurai Sultans and led to the Vijayanagar Empire stretching to contain the entirety of South India up to Rameswaram. This is described in Madura-Vijayam.
- 9 The Vijayanagar Empire and Bahmani kingdoms also tussled for many years. The main areas of contention were
 - ✓ Raichur Doab (between Krishna and Tungabhadra)
 - ✓ Fertile areas of Krishna-Godavari Delta.



DELHI SULTANATE
(Tughlaq)

SAMMA
(De.)

SULTANATE
OF
BENGAL

GUJARAT SULTANATE

GONDWANA
STATES

BAHMANI
SULTANATE

GODAVARI

KRISHANA

EASTERN GANGAS

TUNGABHADRA

REDDIS

RAICHUR
(KARNATAKA)

Bay of Bengal

Arabian Sea

KRISHNA
STATES

VIJAYANAGARA
EMPIRE

RAIGAMA

MADURAI
SULTANATE

1336 AD



1377 AD



VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - SANGAM DYNASTY

HARIHARA II (1377-1406 AD)



- 1 The Vijayanagara empire embarked on expansion towards the eastern sea coast under his reign
- 2 During this period alliance of Warangal and the Bahmani Sultanate occurred which lasted for over 50 years
- 3 Harihara II was able to maintain his position in the face of the Bahmani - Warangal alliance. He had won Goa and Belgaon from Bahamanis.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

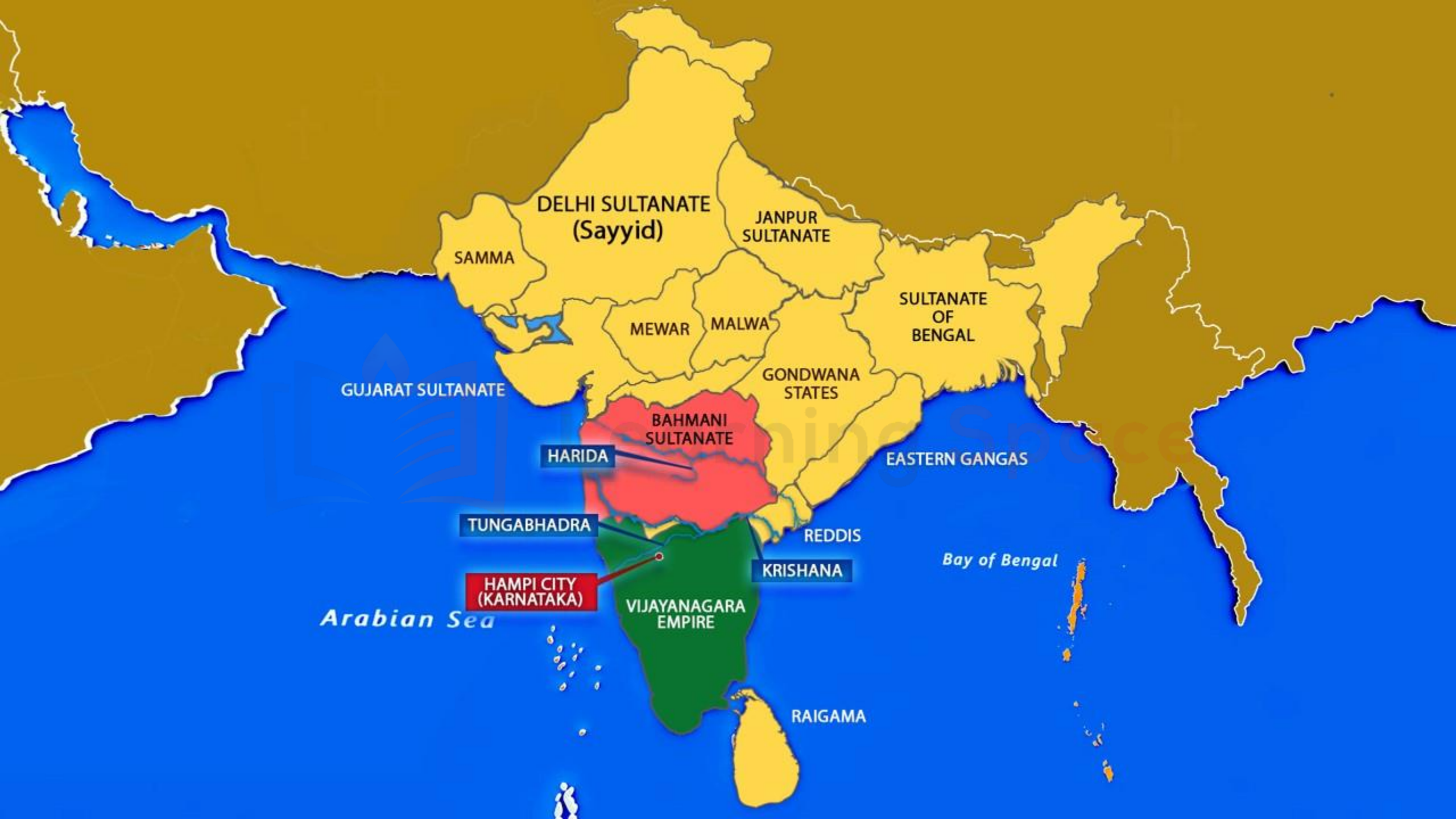
VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - SANGAM DYNASTY

DEVA RAYA I

(1406–1422 AD)



- 1 He was a very capable ruler noted for his military exploits and his support to irrigation works in his kingdom.
- 2 He constructed a dam across river Tungabhadra to bring canals into the city to relieve the shortage of water.
- 3 He also built a dam on the river Haridra for irrigation purposes.
- 4 Throughout his reign, Deva Raya was continually at war with different kingdoms.
- 5 In his reign, he was defeated by the Bahmani ruler Firoz Shah (Battle of Paangul) and had to not only pay a huge indemnity but also had to marry his daughter to the Sultan.



DELHI SULTANATE
(Saiyyid)

JANPUR
SULTANATE

SAMMA

MEWAR

MALWA

SULTANATE
OF
BENGAL

GUJARAT SULTANATE

GONDWANA
STATES

BAHMANI
SULTANATE

HARIDA

EASTERN GANGAS

TUNGABHADRA

REDDIS

HAMPI CITY
(KARNATAKA)

KRISHANA

Arabian Sea

VIJAYANAGARA
EMPIRE

Bay of Bengal

RAIGAMA

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - SANGAM DYNASTY

DEVA RAYA I

(1406–1422 AD)



- 6 But this marriage could buy peace only for a short time and later, with the ruler of Warangal on his side, Deva Raya I in 1420 AD defeated Firoz Shah.
- 7 He modernised the Vijayanagar army by improving the cavalry, employing Turkic archers, and procuring horses from Arabia and Persia.
- 8
 - He maintained a secular attitude in administrative matters.
 - He had 10,000 Muslims in his army, being the first Vijaynagara king to do so.
 - He had a mosque and a slaughterhouse constructed for the convenience of the Muslim soldiers in his army.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - SANGAM DYNASTY

DEVA RAYA I

(1406–1422 AD)



9 Italian traveller, **Nicolo Conti** (in 1420 AD), and Russian merchant **Nikitin** (author of Voyage to India), visited during his reign.

10 **Nicolo Conti** commented on Vijayanagara and Deva Raya I that “In this city, there are 90,000 men fit to bear arms... their king is more powerful than all the kings of India”.

11 The noted **Hazare Rama temple**, an excellent example of Deccan architecture, was believed to be constructed during his rule, though some historians claim it was built during the rule of Deva Raya 2

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - SANGAM DYNASTY

DEVA RAYA I (C.1406–1422 CE)



12 The credit for making the capital city of the Vijayanagar kingdom one of the biggest cities in the 15th century goes to him.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - SANGAM DYNASTY

DEVA RAYA II

(1425–1446 AD)



- 1 Deva Raya II is the greatest of the Sangama dynasty rulers who was an able administrator and an ambitious warrior.
- 2 He authored well-known works:
 - in the Kannada language (Sobagina Sone and Amaruka)
 - in the Sanskrit language (Mahanataka Sudha-nidhi).
 - He also wrote a commentary on the Brahmasutra.
- 3 Some of the most noted Kannada poets of the medieval period, such as Chama-rasa and Kumara Vyasa gained his patronage.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - SANGAM DYNASTY

DEVA RAYA II

(1425–1446 AD)

- 4 The
- Sanskrit poet Gunda Dimdima
 - Telugu poet Kavisarvabhauma (Emperor among Poets)

- 5 The noted South Indian mathematician, Parameshvara, from the Kerala school of astronomy and mathematics lived in his kingdom.

- 6 He acquired the title of Gajabetegara, which literally means “Hunter of Elephants”, an honorific title that explained his addiction to hunting elephants or a metaphor referring to his victories against enemies who were “as strong as elephants”.

- 7 Deva Raya II extended and held territories up to the Krishna river.

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE

VIJAYANAGARA EMPIRE - SANGAM DYNASTY

DEVA RAYA II

(1425–1446 AD)



8

- According to an account of the visiting Persian chronicler **Abdur Razzak**, Deva Raya II's empire extended
 - ✓ From **Ceylon to Gulbarga**, and
 - ✓ **Orissa to the Malabar**
- According to **Nicolo Conti**, the king levied tribute on
 - ✓ Ceylon
 - ✓ Quilon
 - ✓ Pegu and
 - ✓ Pulicat.

NOTE:

- **Virupaksha II**, the last ruler of Sangam Dynasty was overthrown by **Saluva Narsimha** in 1486.
- The Saluva dynasty ruled for a **brief period (1486-1509)**.



DELHI SULTANATE
(Sayyid)

JANPUR
SULTANATE

SAMMA

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OF
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MEWAR

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VIJAYANAGARA
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Bay of Bengal

Arabian Sea

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SINCERE THANKS
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